

IT HAS A NAME · MANAGEMENT MADE SIMPLE

PILLAR 6.1 · SYSTEM VS. EFFORT
PERFORMANCE, GOALS AND METRICS

PRODUCTIVITY

Productivity is a result, not motion.

How to tell whether the team delivers or just looks
busy.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

A full calendar and a tired Friday come with both.

THE CASCADE

How effort becomes the only metric.

WHAT YOU SEE

With no clear yardstick, you measure what is easy to count...

THE MECHANISM

...hours, closed tasks, meetings attended...

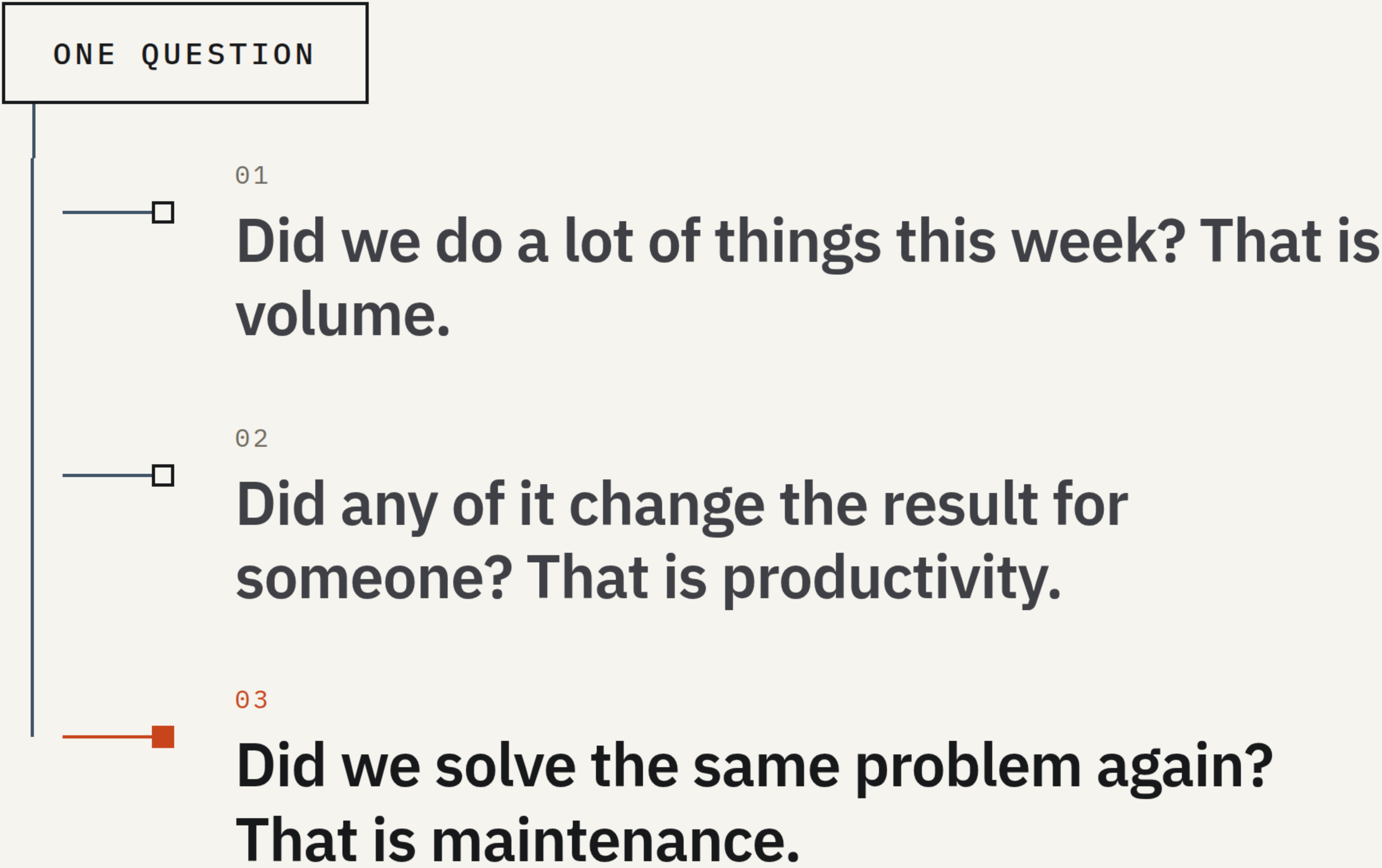
THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the team optimizes for looking busy, because that is what counts.

People chase what gets measured, even when it makes no sense.

THE FORK

One question separates the two.



High volume with a flat result is the portrait of a busy team.

THE METHOD

The team's four vital signs.



01 CYCLE TIME

how long from request to delivery, and whether it is falling

02 STALLED QUEUE

how many items are stuck, and for how long

03 CUSTOMER PERCEPTION

what changed for whoever receives the work

04 TEAM IMPROVEMENTS

how many of their ideas actually got implemented

Four numbers, once a month. If all four sit still, you are in maintenance.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Fast diagnosis, direct action.

01 • CYCLE TIME

Long cycle.

look for waiting and approvals, not for missing effort

02 • STALLED
QUEUE

Queue growing.

stop accepting new work before you unblock the exit

03 • CUSTOMER
PERCEPTION

Client notices nothing.

the team is working on what does not change their life

04 • TEAM
IMPROVEMENTS

Zero improvements.

either there is no room to think, or nobody believes it helps

TWO MODELS

A busy team or a productive team.

THE COMMON MODEL

Busy

Fixes the same fault every month

Measures hours and tasks

The client sees no difference

Nobody proposes a change

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Productive

Fixes the cause and it stays fixed

Measures cycle, queue and effect

The client notices and says so

The team brings improvements itself

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three illusions of productivity.

01 Confusing speed with direction.

- delivering the wrong thing fast costs more than delivering slowly.

02 Celebrating the volume of closed tasks.

- whoever wants that number up just has to slice the tasks smaller.

03 Reading overtime as commitment.

- recurring overtime is a symptom of badly designed work.

| If the yardstick rewards motion, the team delivers motion.

THE CHAIN

The erased week test.

01

Imagine the team's whole week disappeared.



02

What would the client or the operation feel?



03

If the answer is nothing, that was a busy week, not a productive one.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Run that test every Friday, with the team. It changes Monday's conversation.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to install the yardstick this week.



STEP 01

Measure the cycle time of one type of delivery.

from request to delivery, with a start and end date, nothing fancy



STEP 02

List whatever has been stuck the longest.

the oldest item in the queue points at the real bottleneck



STEP 03

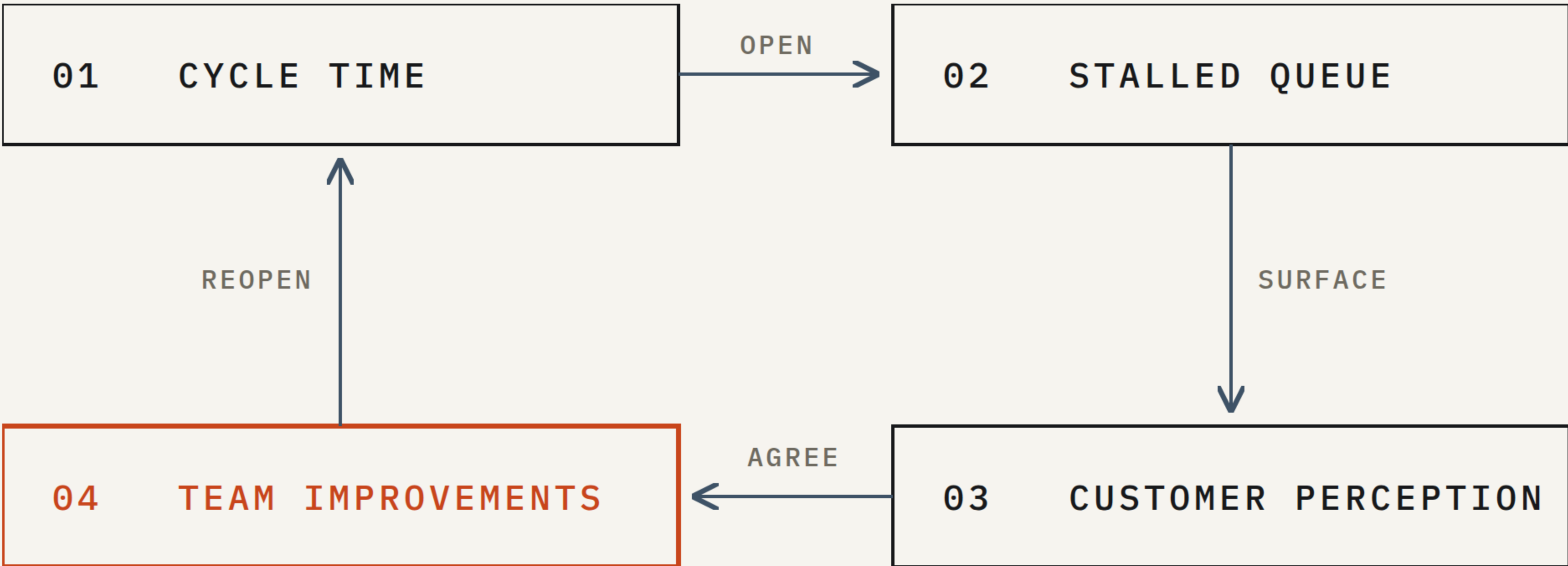
Ask one internal client what improved this month.

if they cannot answer, you have your diagnosis

With no yardstick, effort becomes the only available metric.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Vital Signs, a loop and not a list.



Productivity is not motion. It is what changes when the week ends.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
in your team's next retrospective.

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